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The 10X Rule

by Grant Cardone

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CHAPTER 1

What Is the 10X Rule?

What Is the 10X Rule? The 10X Rule is the one thing that will guarantee that you will get what you want in amounts greater than you ever thought imaginable. It can work in every area of life—spiritual, physical, mental, emotional, familial, and financial. The 10X Rule is based on understanding how much effort and thought are required to get anything done successfully. Chances are that if you look back over your life, you'll see that you have wildly underestimated both the actions and reasoning necessary to accomplish any endeavor to the point where it could be labeled successful.

Although I myself have done well in the first part of the 10X Rule—assessing the level of effort necessary to realize a goal—I failed the second part of the 10X Rule: adjusting my thinking so that I dare to dream at levels previously unimaginable. I will discuss both facets in detail. I have been studying success for the better part of three decades and have found that although there is much agreement about goal setting, discipline, persistence, focus, time management, leveraging through good people, and networking, 1
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THE 10X RULE I've never been clear on that one thing that really makes the difference.

I have been asked hundreds of times in seminars and interviews, “What is that one quality/action/mind-set that will ensure a person creates extraordinary success?” This question has nagged me to understand if there was one thing in my own life that made a difference: “What one thing have I done that made the biggest difference?” I don’t have some gene that others are missing, and I definitely haven’t been lucky.

I was not connected to the “right” people, and I didn’t go to some blue-blood school. So what was it that made me successful? As I look back over my life, I see that the one thing that was most consistent with any success I’ve achieved was that I always put forth 10 times the amount of activity that others did. For every sales presentation, phone call, or appointment others made, I was making 10 of each.

When I started buying real estate, I looked at 10 times more properties than I could buy and then made offers to ensure that I was able to buy what I wanted at the price I desired. I have approached all my business enterprises with massive action; that has been the single biggest determining factor in any success I have created. I was a complete unknown when I built my first company without a business plan.

I had zero know-how or connections, and the only money I had was generated by new sales. However, I was able to build a sound, viable business just by utilizing and operating at activity levels far beyond what others considered reasonable. I made a name for

myself—and literally changed an industry as a result. Let me be clear here: I do not think that I’ve created extraordinary levels of success, nor do I think I have tapped into my full potential.

I am completely aware that there are many people who are many times more successful—at least financially—than me. Although I am not Warren Buffett, Steve Jobs, or one of the founders of Facebook or Google, I have created multiple companies from scratch that have allowed me to have an overall enjoyable lifestyle. The reason CC0011..iinnndddd 22 33//1144//1111 1100::2299::0077 AAMM What Is the 10X Rule? 3 why I didn’t create extraordinary levels of financial success is because I violated the second part of the 10X Rule: the 10X way of thinking.

That would be my only regret: failing to approach my life with the right mind-set. I would have actually set targets that were 10 times what I had dreamed of in the beginning. But, like you, I am working on it now—and I still have a few years to correct this. I mention the notion of creating “extraordinary levels” of success time and again throughout this book. Extraordinary by definition means anything outside the realm of what most normal people can and do achieve.

And of course that definition would then depend on with whom or what class of success you are comparing yourself. Before you say, “I don’t need extraordinary levels of success” or “success is not everything” or “I just want to be happy” or whatever else you may be mumbling to yourself at this very moment, understand

something: in order to get to the next level of whatever you're doing, you must think and act in a wildly different way than you previously have been.

You cannot get to the next phase of a project without a grander mind-set, more acceleration, and extra horsepower. Your thoughts and actions are the reasons why you are where you are right now. So it would be reasonable to be suspect of both! Let's say you have a job but no savings and want to have another \$1,000 a month coming in. Or perhaps you currently have \$20,000 in the bank and want to save \$1 million or that your company is doing \$1 million a year in sales and you want to get to \$100 million.

Maybe you need to find a job, lose 40 pounds, or find the right partner. Although these scenarios cover different areas of your life, they all have one thing in common: the person who desires them is not there yet. Each of these goals is valuable, and each will require a different way of conceptualizing and acting upon them in order to attain them. All of them can be defined as extraordinary if they exceed what you have come to know as ordinary.

While it might not be "exceptional" compared with what others are, the goal you set should always move you to a better place—or toward an objective you've not yet achieved. Others might have an opinion about your success—but only you can decide if it is extraordinary. Only you know your true potential and whether you're living up to it; no one else can judge

your success.

Remember: Success is the degree or measure of attaining some desired object or end. Once you attain this desired end, the issue then becomes whether you can maintain, multiply, and repeat your actions in order to sustain that result. Although success can describe an accomplished feat, people usually don't study success in terms of something they have done. They go at it with a mind toward something they are seeking to do.

An interesting thing about success is that it's like a breath of air; although your last breath of air is important, it's not nearly as important as the next one. No matter how much you've already achieved, you will desire to continue making accomplishments in the future. If you stop trying to succeed, it's like trying to live the rest of your life off the last breath of air. Things change; nothing remains as it was—for things to be maintained, they require attention and action.

After all, a marriage cannot maintain itself off the love felt on the wedding day. But people who are highly successful—in both their professional and personal lives—continue to work and produce and create even after they've flourished. The world watches these people with amazement and confusion, asking questions like, “Why do they keep pushing?” The answer is simple: Extremely successful people know that their efforts must continue in order for them to realize new achievements.

Once the hunt for a desired object or goal is abandoned, the cycle of success comes to an end. Someone said to me recently, “It is clear you have made enough money to live comfortably; why are you still pushing?” It is because I am obsessed with the next breath of accomplishment. I am compulsive about leaving a legacy and making a positive footprint on the planet. I am most unhappy when I am not

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AAMM What Is the 10X Rule?

I am most happy when I am in quest of reaching my full potential and abilities. My disappointment or dissatisfaction with where I am at this moment does not suggest that something is wrong with me but rather that something is right with me. I believe that it is my ethical obligation to create success for myself, my family, my company, and my future. No one can convince me that there’s something wrong with my desire to achieve new levels of success.

Should I be happy with the love I have for my children and wife yesterday—or should I continue to create and pour it on in new amounts today and tomorrow? The reality is that most people do not have whatever they define as success; many want “something more” in at least one area of their lives. Indeed, these are the people who will read this book—the unsatisfied who yearn for something more.

And really, who doesn’t want more: better relationships, more quality time with those they love, more momentous experiences, a better level of fitness and health, increased energy, more spiritual

knowledge, and the ability to contribute to the good of society? Common to all of these is the desire to improve, and they are qualities by which countless people measure success. Regardless of what you want to do or be—whether it is to lose 10 pounds, write a book, or become a billionaire—your desire to reach these points is an incredibly important element of doing so.

Each of these goals is vital to your future survival— because they indicate what’s within your potential. Regardless of the goal you are striving to accomplish, you will be required to think differently, embrace a die-hard level of commitment, and take massive amounts of action at 10 times the levels you think necessary—followed by more actions. Almost every problem people face in their careers and other aspects of their lives—such as failed diets, marriages, and financial problems— are all the result of not taking enough action.

So before you say to yourself for the millionth time, “I would be happy if I just had . . .” or “I don’t want to be rich— just comfortable” or “I just want enough to be happy,” you must understand one vital point: Limiting the amount of success CC0011..iinndddd 55 33//1144//1111 1100::2299::0077 AAMM 6 THE 10X RULE you desire is a violation of the 10X Rule in and of itself.

When people start limiting the amount of success they desire, I assure you they will limit what will be required of them in order to achieve success and will fail miserably at doing what it takes to keep it. This is the focus of the 10X Rule: You must set targets that are 10

times what you think you want and then do 10 times what you think it will take to accomplish those targets.

Massive thoughts must be followed by massive actions. There is nothing ordinary about the 10X Rule. It is simply what it says it is: 10 times the thoughts and 10 times the actions of other people. The 10X Rule is about pure domination mentality. You never do what others do. You must be willing to do what they won't do—and even take actions that you might deem “unreasonable.” This domination mentality is not about controlling others; rather, it's about being a model for others' thoughts and actions.

Your mind-set and deeds should serve as gauges by which people can measure themselves. 10X people never approach a target aiming to achieve just that goal. Instead, they're looking to dominate the entire sector—and will take unreasonable actions in order to do so. If you start any task with a mind toward limiting the potential outcome, you will limit the actions necessary to accomplish that very goal. The following is the basic series of mistakes people make when setting out to achieve goals: 1.

Mistargeting by setting objectives that are too low and don't allow for enough correct motivation. 2. Severely underestimating what it will take in terms of actions, resources, money, and energy to accomplish the target. 3. Spending too much time competing and not enough time dominating their sector. 4. Underestimating the amount of adversity they will need to overcome in order to actually attain their desired goal. CC0011..iinndddd 66 33//1144//1111

7 The foreclosure issue that America is facing right now is a perfect example of this sequence of missteps. Those who fell victim to this situation were mistargeting, underestimating necessary amounts of actions, and concentrating too intensely on being competitive rather than creating a situation that would make them invincible to unexpected setbacks. People were operating with a herd mentality—one based on competition instead of domination—during the housing boom. They thought in terms of “I have to do what my colleague/ neighbor/family member is doing” instead of “I have to do what’s best for me.”

Despite what many people claim (or want to believe), the truth is that every person who had a negative experience regarding the housing collapse and foreclosure mess did not correctly set his or her goals for survival. The number of foreclosures then impacted people’s home values across the country. And when the real estate market crumbled, it negatively impacted everything—affecting even those who weren’t playing the real estate game. Unemployment suddenly doubled and then tripled.

As a result, industries were crippled, companies were shut down, and retirement accounts were wiped out. Even the most sophisticated of investors misjudges the correct amount of financial wealth necessary to weather this kind of storm. You can blame the banks, the Fed, mortgage brokers, timing, bad fortune, or even God if you like, but the reality of the situation is that every person

(including myself!), as well as countless banks, companies, and even entire industries, failed to appropriately assess the situation.

When people don't set 10X goals—and therefore fail to operate at 10X levels—they become susceptible to “get-rich-quick” phenomena and unplanned changes in the marketplace. If you had occupied yourself with your own actions—aimed at dominating your sector—you probably would not have been baited by these kinds of temptations. I know because it happened to me. I myself got caught up in this situation because I had not properly set my own targets at 10X levels and became susceptible to someone else's racket.

Someone approached me, gained my trust, and claimed to be able to make me money if I would only join forces with him and his company. Because I didn't have enough “skin” in my own games, I was drawn in, and he hurt me—badly. Had I set my own targets properly, I would have been so preoccupied with doing what was necessary to accomplish them that I wouldn't have even had time to meet with this crook.

If you look around, you will likely see that humankind, by and large, tends to set targets at subpar levels. Many people, in fact, have been programmed to set targets that are not even of their own design. We are told what is considered to be “a lot of money”—what is rich, poor, or middle class. We have predetermined notions about what is fair, what is difficult, what is possible, what is ethical, what is

good, what is bad, what is ugly, what tastes good, what looks good, and on and on.

So don't assume that your goal setting isn't impinged upon by these already-established parameters, too. Any goal you set is going to be difficult to achieve, and you will inevitably be disappointed at some points along the way. So why not set these goals much higher than you deem worthy from the beginning? If they are going to require work, effort, energy, and persistence, then why not exert 10 times as much of each?

What if you are underestimating your capabilities? Oh, you might be protesting, but what of the disappointment that comes from setting unrealistic goals? Take just a few moments to study history, or—even better—simply look back over your life. Chances are that you have more often been disappointed by setting targets that are too low and achieving them—only to be shocked that you still didn't get what you wanted. Another school of thought is that you shouldn't set “unrealistic” goals because they might compel you to give up when you realize you can't reach them.

But wouldn't coming up short on a 10X target accomplish more than coming up short on one-tenth of that goal? Let's say that my original aim CC0011..iinndddd 88 33//1144//1111 1100::2299::0077 AAMM What Is the 10X Rule? 9 was to make \$100,000, which I then changed to \$1 million. Which of these goals would you rather come up short on? Some people claim that expectations are the reason for unhappiness. However, I can assure you from personal

experience that you'll suffer greatly by setting subpar targets.

You simply will not invest the energy, effort, and resources necessary to accommodate unexpected variables and conditions that are certain to occur sometime during the course of the project or event. Why spend your life making only enough money to end up with not enough money? Why work out in the gym only once a week, just to get sore and never see a change in your body type? Why get merely “good” at something when you know the marketplace only rewards excellence?

Why work eight hours a day at a job where no one recognizes you when you could be a superstar—and perhaps even run or own the place? All these examples require energy. Only your 10X targets really pay off! So let's return to our definition of success—a term most people have never even looked up, much less studied. What does it really mean to have success or be successful?

In the Middle Ages, the word often referred to the person taking over the throne. The word derived from the Latin *succeder* (now—that is real power!). “Succeed” literally means “to turn out well or to attain a desired object or end.” Success, then, is an accumulation of events turning out well or desired outcomes being achieved. Think of it this way: you wouldn't consider a diet “successful” if you lost 10 pounds and put on 12.

In other words, you have to be able to keep success—not just get it. You would also want to improve upon that success to ensure that you do maintain it. After all, you can cut your grass once and be

successful in doing so, but it's going to grow back eventually. You will have to constantly maintain the yard in order for it to continue to be defined as a success.

This isn't about attaining one goal one time but rather about what we can persist in creating. CC0011..iinndddd 99 33//1144//1111 1100::2299::0077 AAMM 10 THE 10X RULE Before you start worrying that you're going to have to work at this forever, let me assure you that you won't—that is, not if you set the correct 10X target from the beginning. Talk to anyone who is wildly, extraordinarily successful in some field, and they will tell you it never felt like work.

It feels like work to most people because the payoff is not substantial enough and doesn't yield an adequate victory to feel like something that isn't "work." Your focus should be on the kind of success that builds upon itself—that which is perpetual and doesn't happen only one time. This book is about how to create extraordinary achievement, how to ensure you will attain it, how to keep it— and then how to keep creating new levels of it without it feeling like work.

Remember: A person who limits his or her potential success will limit what he or she will do to create it and keep it. It's also vital to keep in mind that the subject of acquirement—in other words, the goal or target—doesn't matter as much as the mind-set and actions that are mandatory to accomplish 10X goals. Whether you want to be a professional speaker, best-selling author, top CEO, exceptional

parent, great teacher; have a model marriage; get in great shape; or produce a movie that the world talks about for generations, you'll be required to move beyond where you are right now and commit to 10X thoughts and actions.

Any desirable target or goal will always suggest something you have yet to accomplish. It doesn't matter how much you've already attained. As long as you are alive, you will either live to accomplish your own goals and dreams or be used as a resource to accomplish someone else's. For the sake of this book, success can also be defined as accomplishing the next level of what it is you desire—and in ways that will forever change how you perceive yourself, your life, the use of your energy, and—perhaps most significantly—how others perceive you.

The 10X Rule is about what you have to think and do to get to a point 10 times more gratifying than you have ever experienced. What Is the 10X Rule? 11 imagined. This level of success cannot be achieved by “normal” levels of thoughts and actions. That is why even when most of those goals are attained, they don't actually provide sufficient fulfillment.

Average marriages, bank accounts, weight, health, businesses, products, and the like are just that—average. Are you ready for the 10X adventure? 12 THE 10X RULE Exercise What are the two parts of the 10X Rule? What are the four biggest mistakes

people make when setting goals? Why is it a problem to set a goal too low? Are you ready to 10X? CC0011..iinndddd 1122 33//1144//1111 1100::2299::0077 AAMM CHAPTER 2 Why the 10X Rule Is Vital Before we get into how important it is for you to think and operate according to the 10X Rule, let me share a little of my own story.

For every project in which I have ever been involved, I underestimated the time, energy, money, and effort necessary to bring my project to the point of success. Any client I targeted or new sector of business into which I ventured has always taken 10 times more mail, calls, e-mails, and contacts than I had originally predicted. Even getting my wife to date and eventually marry me took 10 times more effort and energy than I had calculated (but it was worth every bit!).

Regardless of how superior your product, service, or proposition is, I assure you that there will be something you don't anticipate or correctly plan. Economic changes, legal matters, competition, resistance to converting, too new of a product banks freezing up, market uncertainty, technology changes, people problems . . . more people problems, elections, war, strikes—these are just a few of the potential “unexpected events.” I don't say this to scare you but instead to 13 CC0022..iinndddd 1133 33//1144//1111 1100::4499::4477 AAMM 14 THE 10X RULE prepare you for where the biggest opportunities exist.

10X thinking and actions are vital; they are the only things that will get you through these events. Money alone cannot do it; it can help, but it can't do the job for you. If you march into any battle without the proper troops, supplies, ammunition, and staying power, you will return home defeated. It's as simple as that. It's not enough to occupy a territory. You have to be able to keep it.

I started my first business when I was 29 years old. Most people won't go into business for themselves because they aren't willing to take the financial haircut necessary. I had prepared for this—or so I thought—and assumed that it would take me three months to get to the income level of the job I previously had. Well, it took me almost three years to get my business to provide me with the same income of the previous job.

That was 12 times longer than I had expected. And I almost quit after three months—not because of the money but because of the amount of resistance and disappointment I experienced. I had a very specific list of reasons why my company wasn't going to work. I had compiled it in an attempt to talk myself out of continuing. I was beyond disappointed; I was distraught and all but destroyed.

I literally went to a friend and said, "I can't do this anymore—I'm done." I made up reason after reason why it wasn't working out—the clientele didn't have the money, the economy sucked, the timing was wrong, I was too young, my clients didn't get it, people didn't want to change, I sucked, they sucked—and on and on. I eventually realized—after spending so much time trying to figure

out why things weren't working out—that it was completely possible that I was missing the answer entirely.

I never considered that I had merely incorrectly estimated what it would take to move a new product into the marketplace at the very beginning of the process. I had presented a new idea, for sure, but it wasn't one that anyone had asked for. I had limited funds, so I wasn't able to hire people and couldn't afford CC0022..iinndddd 1144 33//1144//1111 1100::4499::4477 AAMM Why the 10X Rule Is Vital 15 to advertise—which was unfortunate because no one knew me or my company.

I didn't know what I was doing and was cold calling other organizations. If this was going to work, it would depend on my ability to increase my efforts—not my excuses. Once I quit calculating all the wrong reasons, I committed to making this work by increasing my efforts 10 times. And as soon as I did that, everything started to change—immediately. I went back into the marketplace with the right estimation of effort and started seeing results.

Instead of making two to three sales calls a day, I started doing 20 to 30. When I ramped up my full commitment and aligned the correct levels of thought and action, the market started responding to me. It was still hard, and I was disappointed from time to time. But I was getting four times the results by making 10 times the effort. When you have underestimated the time, energy, and effort necessary to do something, you will have “quit” in your mind, voice,

posture, face, and presentation.

You won't develop the persistence necessary to get your mission accomplished. However, when you correctly estimate the effort necessary, you will assume the appropriate posture. The marketplace will sense by your actions that you are a force to be reckoned with and are not going away—and it will begin to respond accordingly. I have consulted with thousands of individuals and companies over the past 20 years—and I have never seen one of them correctly estimate effort and think.

Whether it was building a house, raising money, fighting a legal battle, getting a job, selling a new product, learning a new position, getting promoted, making a movie, or finding the right partner in life, it always took more than what people calculated. I have yet to meet anyone who claims that any of these things was easy. Achieving these goals may seem easy to those who are on the outside looking in, but those who know firsthand what it took would never make such a statement.

When you miscalculate the efforts you need to make something happen, you become visibly disappointed and discouraged. This causes you to incorrectly identify the problem. CC0022..iinndddd 1155 33//1144//1111 1100::4499::4477 AAMM 16 THE 10X RULE and sooner or later assume that the target is unattainable and ultimately throw in the towel. Most people's—including managers'—first response is to reduce the target rather than increase their activity. I have watched sales managers in

organizations do this for years with sales teams.

They give a quota or agree on a target at the beginning of the quarter and then midway through find they are unable to reach the target, so they hold a meeting and reduce the target to some more attainable figure in order for the team to stay motivated and have a chance of winning. This major mistake should never even cross your mind as an option. It sends the wrong message to the organization—that targets are unimportant and the only way to win is to move the finish line.

A great manager will push a person to do more at the risk of coming up short, not target less. This idea of changing targets to make everyone feel good will lead to a further weakening of morale, hope, expectations, and skills, and everyone will start assigning reasons—better known as excuses—as to why the team is unable to attain its targets. Never reduce a target. Instead, increase actions. When you start rethinking your targets, making up excuses, and letting yourself off the hook, you are giving up on your dreams!

These actions should be an indication that you're getting off track—that you should begin thinking in terms of correcting your initial estimation of effort. The 10X Rule assumes the target is never the problem. Any target attacked with the right actions in the right amounts with persistence is attainable. Even if I want to visit another planet, I must assume that the right actions taken in the right amounts over whatever time necessary will allow me to accomplish this.

When people inadequately measure the actions necessary, they inevitably start to rationalize. Mankind seems to have this builtin, automatic calculator whose only purpose is to explain away failure. The problem is that the first and most often used calculations always seem to target something other than activity level. This calculator tends to be more emotional than logical;

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Even if I want to visit another planet, I must assume that the right actions taken in the right amounts over whatever time necessary will allow me to accomplish this. When people inadequately measure the actions necessary, they inevitably start to rationalize. Mankind

seems to have this builtin, automatic calculator whose only purpose is to explain away failure. The problem is that the first and most often used calculations always seem to target something other than activity level.

This calculator tends to be more emotional than logical; CC0022..iinndddd 1166 33//1144//1111 1100::4499::4477 AAMM Why the 10X Rule Is Vital 17 it judges the project, clientele, economy, and individual to be deficient as a means of justifying why things are not working out. This is probably due to all the false content that has been loaded into the calculations by the media, educational system, and our upbringings—excuses like, “the market isn’t ready,” “the economy is bad,” “this isn’t wanted,” “I’m not cut out for this,” “our targets were unrealistic,” and on and on.

But more often than not, it’s simply that you just haven’t correctly assessed the amount of action necessary. Regardless of the timing, the economy, the product, or how big your venture is, the right acts done to the right degree over time will make you successful. I can assure you from experience—after 30 years of building companies and bringing new products and ideas to market—that there will be something you will never foresee, regardless of how detailed your business plan is.

I don’t care if your product cost nothing to make and it’s 100 times superior to its closest competitor; you will still have to apply 10 times more effort just to push through all the noise in order to get people to even know about it. Assume that every project you attempt

will take more time, money, energy, effort, and people than you can imagine. Multiply every expectation you have by 10, and you will probably be safe.

And if it doesn't take 10 times more than anticipated, great. It is better to be pleasantly surprised than greatly disappointed. If you want to save time in getting your idea or product to market, then you must make sure you do 10 times more of everything in order to be in more places with more people over shorter durations. For example, if you planned on it taking one person to pitch your idea, then plan on it taking 10 people in order to possibly be able to reduce the time it takes.

But remember—10 times more people will take 10 times more money, and someone will have to manage those people. 10X parameters allow for a variety of unplanned variables that can strike at any point during a project: employee problems, lawsuits, economic swings, national or global events, competition, illness, and so forth. Add to this list any marketplace CC0022..iinndddd 1177 33//1144//1111 1100::4499::4477 AAMM 18 THE 10X RULE resistance to your projects, people being set in their ways, shifts in technology, and, well, you have a whole slew of additional potential events.

For some reason, people who develop an idea about something they want to bring to the market tend to embrace a sense of optimism that frequently causes them to grossly misjudge what it will take to complete their project. While enthusiasm for any project is clearly

important, you cannot forget one important fact: Your potential customers are not as enthusiastic about this project—because they don’t even know about it yet.

The potential market is likely just starting to wrap its head around the notion. Then, too, there is the possibility of apathy—that there will be no interest whatsoever. I’m not telling you to be pessimistic; just be prepared. Tackle your project with the 10X Rule—like your life depends on it. Manage every action as though you have a camera on you every step of the way. Pretend you’re being recorded as a model by which your children and grandchildren will learn how to succeed in life.

Attack everything with the ferociousness of a champion athlete who is getting his last opportunity to claim his pages in the history books. And always remember to follow through completely: That is the great common denominator of all winners. They see every action through to completion. Make no excuses, and adopt a “take-no-prisoners” attitude. Approach every situation with an “in-it-to-win-itwhatever-it-takes” mind-set. Sound too aggressive? Sorry, but that is the outlook required to win nowadays.

I know you’ve probably heard this before, but success does not merely “happen.” It is the result of relentless, proper actions taken over time. Only those who operate with the appropriate view and corresponding actions will have success. Luck clearly has something to do with it, but anyone who is “getting lucky” will tell you that their “luck” is directly proportional to what they’ve done. The more

actions you take, the better your chances are of getting “lucky.”

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AAMM Why the 10X Rule Is Vital 19 Exercise What is the first reaction that most people—including managers—have when they are not hitting their targets? When you start making excuses for why you aren’t hitting targets, what should that indicate to you? Fill in the following. The 10X Rule assumes the target is never . Any target attacked with the right in the right with persistence is ?

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AAMM CC0022..iinndddd 2200 33//1144//1111 1100::4499::4477
AAMM CHAPTER 3 What Is Success? I know I’ve already used the term success several times, but let’s clarify what it actually is. It probably means something different to you than it does to me. The definition really depends on where a person is in life or what has his or her attention. Success in early childhood might mean receiving an allowance for the first time or getting to stay up past one’s bedtime.

But that would no longer be of interest just a few years later, when success in the teen years might mean getting one’s own bedroom, cell phone, or a later curfew. Success in your early 20s might mean furnishing your first apartment and getting your first promotion. Later on, it might be marriage, kids, more promotions, travel, more money. As you age and conditions change, the ways in which you define success will transform yet again.

When you’re much older, you’re likely to find success in good health, family, grandchildren, your legacy, and how you will be

remembered. Where you are in life, the conditions you're facing, and the situations, events, and people on which your attention is most focused will

21 CC0033..iinndddd 2211 33//44//1111 22::3355::1122 PPM 22 THE 10X RULE influence your definition of success. Success can be found in any number of realms—financial, spiritual, physical, mental, emotional, philanthropic, communal, or familial.

However, wherever you find it, the most crucial things to know about success—in order to have it and keep it—are the following: 1. Success is important. 2. Success is your duty. 3. There is no shortage of success. I will discuss the first point in this chapter, and the other two in subsequent chapters. Success Is Important Regardless of their culture, race, religion, economic background, or social group, most people would agree that success is vital to the well-being of the individual, the family unit, and the group—and certainly to the future survival of all of these things.

Success provides confidence, security, a sense of comfort, the ability to contribute at a greater level, and hope and leadership for others in terms of what is possible. Without it, you; your group, company, goals and dreams; and even the entire civilization would cease to survive and thrive. Think of success in terms of expansion. Without continued growth, any entity—be it a corporation, dream, or even an entire race—would cease to exist.

History is full of examples that support the notion that disaster occurs when expansion doesn't continue. We can include the

Vikings, Ancient Rome and Greece, Communist Russia, and an endless list of companies and products. Success is needed in order to perpetuate people, places, and things. You must never reduce success in your mind or in a conversation to something that doesn't matter; on the contrary, it is vital! Anyone who minimizes the importance of success to

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23 your future has given up on his or her own chances of accomplishment and is spending his or her life trying to convince others to do the same. Individuals and groups must actively accomplish their goals and targets in order to carry on. If not, they will either cease to exist or be consumed and become part of something else. Companies and industries that wish to maintain their status must successfully create products; get those products to the market; keep clients, employees, and investors happy; and repeat that cycle over and over.

There are far too many “cute” sayings that seem to dismiss the importance of success, like “Success is a journey, not a destination.” Please! When terrible economic contractions occur, everyone quickly realizes they can't eat or make house payments with cute little sayings. The economic events of the past several years should have made it obvious how badly we all underestimated the importance of success—and how essential it actually is to our survival.

It is not enough just to play the game; it is vital that you learn to win at it. Winning— over and over again—at everything in which you involve yourself ensures that you will be able to further expand. And it guarantees that both you and your ideas will survive into the future. Success is equally important to a person’s sense of self. It promotes confidence, imagination, and a sense of security and emphasizes the significance of making a contribution.

People who are unable to provide for their families and their future put themselves and their families at risk. People who aren’t successful can’t buy goods and services. This can cause an economy to slow down and taxes to diminish, which will then negatively impact funds for schools, hospitals, and public services. About this time, some will say, “But success is not everything,” and of course, it isn’t everything. Yet I always wonder what point people are trying to make with this statement.

When someone in my seminars says this to me, I often respond by asking something along the lines of, “Are you trying to diminish the importance of something you haven’t been able to attain?”

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THE 10X RULE Get real! Regardless of whatever goals you are trying to attain—success is absolutely critical. If you quit caring, then you quit winning; quit winning long enough, and you will just plain quit!

Do kids benefit when they see their moms and dads losing or quitting? Does anyone benefit when you can’t get your art sold or

that great book published or that great idea that will improve everything across? No one will benefit from your failure. However, if you were able to reverse it and attain the goals and dreams you set for yourself—now, that would be something. Exercise What are some cute sayings you have heard about success that diminish its importance?

How would being successful be important to you, and how would it improve your life? CC0033..iinndddd 2244 33//44//1111 22::3355::1122 PPMM CHAPTER 4 Success Is Your Duty One of the greatest turning points in my life occurred when I stopped casually waiting for success and instead started to approach it as a duty, obligation, and responsibility. I literally began to see success as an ethical issue—a duty to my family, company, and future—rather than as something that may or may not happen to me.

I spent 17 years getting a formal education that was to prepare me for the world—and not one course was on success. Not once did anyone talk to me about the importance of success, much less what I had to do in order to get it. Amazing! Years of education, information, hundreds of books, time in class, and money, yet I was still missing a purpose. However, I was fortunate enough to have two distinct experiences in my life that served as major wake-up calls.

My existence and survival were being seriously threatened in both cases. The first occurred when I was 25. My life was a pitiful mess, caused by years of approaching life aimlessly, drifting with no

real purpose or focus. I had no money, plenty of uncertainty, no direction, too much free time, and still hadn't 25 CC0044..iinndddd 2255 33//1144//1111 1100::5555::0011 AAMM 26 THE 10X RULE made a commitment to approach success as an obligation.

Had I not had this realization and gotten serious about my life, I don't think I would be alive today. You know, you don't need to grow old to die. I was dying at the age of 20 as a result of no direction and no purpose. At that time, I couldn't hold a job, had surrounded myself with losers, was terminally hopeless, and if that weren't enough, using drugs and alcohol on a daily basis.

Had I continued on without a serious wake-up call, I would have continued to live a mediocre existence at best and probably much worse. Had I not committed to a life of success, I would not have identified my purpose and would have merely spent a lifetime fulfilling everyone else's purpose. Let's face it, there are plenty of people living mere existences, and I should know. At that time in my life, I was in sales and treated it with disdain.

When I committed to sales as a career and then decided to do whatever I had to in order to become successful at selling, my life changed. My second awakening took place at the age of 50, when the economy was going through the biggest contraction since the Great Depression. Literally every aspect of my life was being put at risk—as it was for billions of other individuals, companies, industries, and even entire economies.

It became evident almost overnight that my company was not powerful enough in its sector, and its future was now in jeopardy. Additionally, my financial well-being was being put in jeopardy. What others thought was tremendous financial wealth was now in danger as well. I remember turning on the TV one day and hearing reports about how unemployment numbers were increasing, wealth was being destroyed due to stock market and housing corrections, homes were being foreclosed on, banks were shutting down, and companies were being bailed out by the government.

I realized then that I had put my family, my companies, and myself in a precarious situation because I had started to rest on my laurels and had discontinued approaching success as my duty, obligation, and responsibility. I had lost my focus and purpose.

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